

# Here Comes Fedora 21, in Three Different Variants!

There are three different variants of Fedora 21—Fedora 21 Cloud, Fedora 21 Server and Fedora 21 Workstation.

Fedora 21 has finally arrived. First appearances suggest that this is a must-try distro for all Linux fans. Notably, it is the first Fedora release influenced by the *Fedora.next* initiative. The project emphasises increased modularity and flexibility from the Fedora OS. There are three different variants of Fedora 21—Fedora 21 Cloud, Fedora 21 Server and Fedora 21 Workstation. This is an entirely new vision, in terms of the users Fedora is targeting and the way this version of the distro has been developed. Fedora has taken a modular approach, allowing developers to keep each version slim and largely optimised for the platform.

Matthew Miller, Fedora project leader, said, “There is no place for monolithic technology in today’s computing world—end users are seeking tailored yet flexible platforms to build their own custom solutions, be it a network server environment, a scale-out application, or a comfortable desktop environment serving as an interface to more complex systems. The Fedora community needed to keep pace with these demands while still delivering the cutting-edge Linux innovation for which we are known. With Fedora 21, we are able to address specific use cases across the desktop, the server room and the cloud, bringing to light new developer tools, enabling specific server roles, and providing a powerful, lightweight host for containerised applications.”

Though all three variants of Fedora 21 are developed to meet specific user demands, each one of them has been developed with a set of packages involving the Linux kernel, RPM, Yum, systemd, and Anaconda.

Yet another notable feature of Fedora 21 is the GNOME software. Similar to the Ubuntu Software Center or the Mac App Store, GNOME software is a front-end for the package management system. It is integrated with GNOME. However, Dash is not installed; so if you search for an application in

Dash, it will open the app in the GNOME software, provided that it is available in the official repositories. It can then be installed with one click.

Here’s what you get with the three variants of Fedora 21.

## Fedora 21 Cloud

Designed to meet computing requirements across different cloud platforms, this variant of Fedora 21 serves images for the private cloud set-up like OpenStack and Amazon Machine Images, for use on Amazon Web Services. It also involves the base image to create Fedora containers.

## Fedora 21 Server

This variant offers a common base platform to manage featured application stacks, while framing a flexible foundation for Web servers, file servers, database servers, and even Platform-as-a-Service (PaaS) deployments. It includes Rolekit (which provides a role deployment and management toolkit for admins), Cockpit (a Web-based user interface for configuring, managing, and monitoring servers) and

OpenLMI (which delivers a remote management system built on top of a Distributed Management Taskforce – Common Information Model).

## Fedora 21 Workstation

The Fedora 21 Workstation is designed to offer streamlined software installation and experimental Wayland support. It comes with the DevAssistant tool, which will help to efficiently carry out the set up process for a large number of language runtime and integrated development environments. 

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